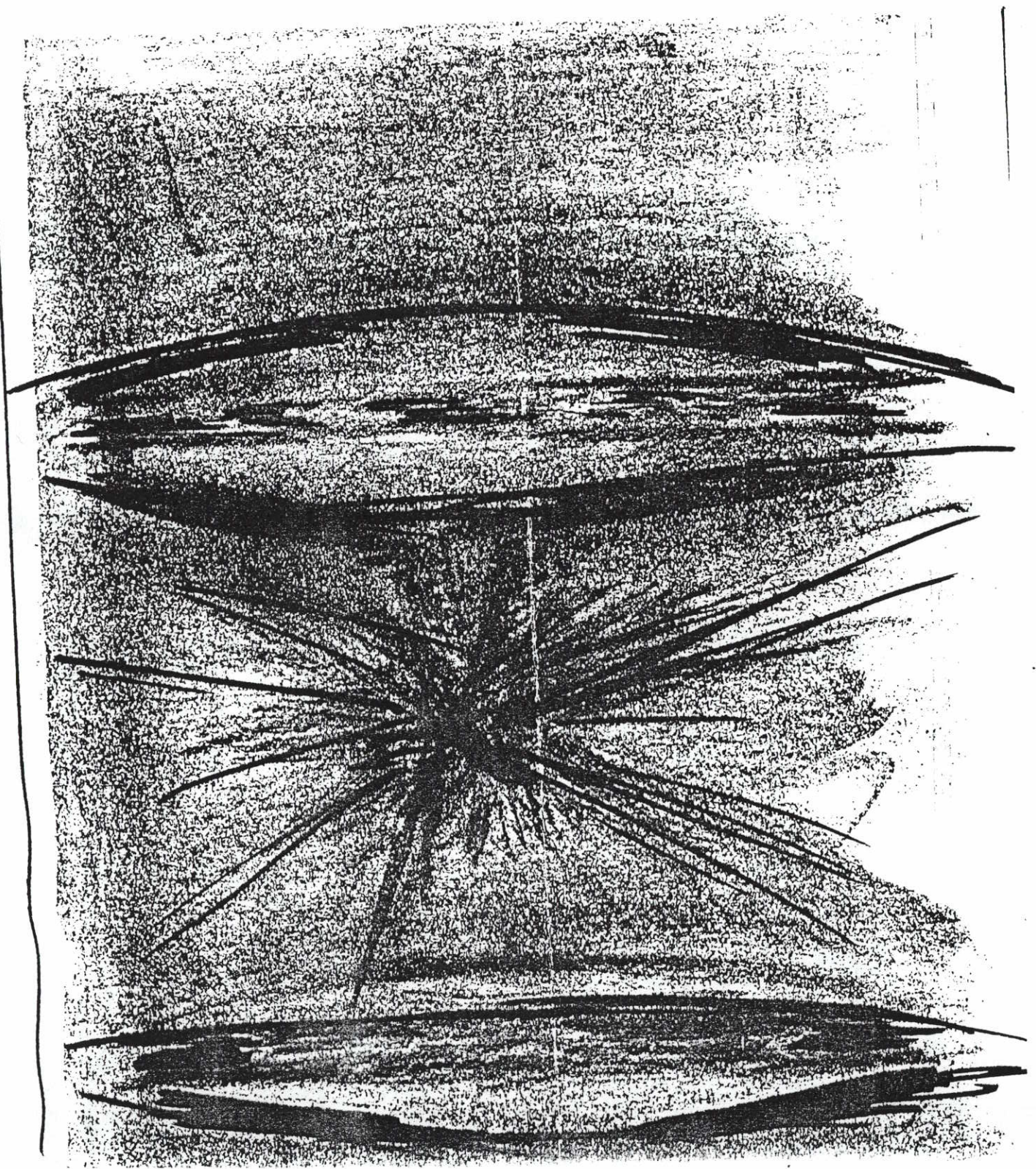


U.F.O. SIGHTING RIO DE JANEIRO-BRAZIL JULY 1956
ABOARD THE AIRCRAFT CARRIER U.S.S. FDR CVA-42

THESE OBJECTS WERE SEEN BY ME AS WELL AS SEVERAL DOZEN OTHERS INCLUDING OFFICERS WHILE CREW MEMBERS OF THE CARRIER FRANKLIN D. ROOSEVELT. THE TIME WAS IN THE EARLY MORNING HOURS OF JULY 26-1956 WHILE AT ANCHOR IN THE PORT OF RIO DE JANEIRO-BRAZIL. MOST OF THE CREW WERE ASLEEP AND UNAWARE OF THE SIGHTINGS. AS MEMBERS OF C.I.C.-RADAR DIV.- THESE OBJECTS WERE WATCHED THROUGH HIGH POWER BINOCULARS FOR SEVERAL MINUTES BEFORE THEY FINALLY VANISHED WITH TREMENDOUS SPEED.

WHEN FIRST SIGHTED THE OBJECTS WERE SUSPENDED IN MID-AIR OVER ONE ANOTHER WITH SEVERAL HUNDRED FEET BETWEEN THEM. A RADAR FIX PLACED THEM SEVERAL MILES FROM THE FDR'S POSITION AT A HEIGHT OF ABOUT 2000 FEET. TWO ROWS OF BRIGHT COUNTER-ROTATING LIGHTS COULD BE SEEN THROUGH THE MIDDLE OF EACH OBJECT THAT MADE THEM APPEAR TO BE ROUND IN SHAPE. FOR SEVERAL MINUTES THEY NEVER MOVED. THEN THE UPPER ONE RELEASED A FIREBALL OBJECT THAT DROPEO INTO THE TOP OF THE LOWER ONE. WITHIN SECONDS THEY BOTH VANISHED WITH TREMENDOUS SPEED. RADAR CONTACT WAS ALMOST IMPOSSIBLE. IT WAS ESTIMATED THE OBJECTS COULD HAVE BEEN BETWEEN 75 AND 100 FEET IN LENGTH. ALL INVOLVED WERE TOLD TO KEEP A TIGHT LIP ON WHAT WE SAW. A REPORT WAS FILED-SIGNED AND SENT TO THE DEFENCE DEPT. ALONG WITH A COLOR SKETCH BY ME OF WHAT WAS WATCHED THAT NIGHT BY MANY.

SINCE MY DISCHARGE FROM THE NAVY IN 1958 I TOLD VERY FEW ABOUT THIS EVENT AND IT WAS ONLY NOW THAT I DECIDED TO SKETCH THESE OBJECTS AGAIN FOR FUTURE REFERENCE ON A POSSIBLE OIL PAINTING.



LEON TREADWELL
256 MORRIS LANE
MILFORD - MAINE
04461.

APRIL 1991

MR. GRUSINSKI:

I RECEIVED YOUR LETTER WITH MUCH INTEREST. I LEFT F.D.R. IN JUNE 1958. I CAN NOT HELP YOU ON THE 1958 SIGHTING BUT I THINK YOU WILL FIND THE ENCLOSED OF INTEREST.

I WAS PART OF THE CREW THAT PUT F.D.R. BACK INTO COMMISSION ON APRIL 6-1956. AT BREMERTON - WASHINGTON. SHE HAD THE BEST RADAR IN THE FLEET. BEFORE THIS I WAS ON U.S.S. MIDWAY CVA-41. I TOOK ADVANCE RADAR SCHOOL AT TREASURE ISLAND IN 1955.

F.D.R. WAS TO REPORT TO MAYPORT - FLORIDA. WE TOOK HER AROUND THE "HORN", SINCE SHE WAS TOO LARGE TO FIT THE PANAMA LOCKS. OUR LAST STOP BEFORE MAYPORT WAS RIO-DE-JANEIRO, BRAZIL.

AT THIS TIME I WAS RD3 AND ON THE NIGHT OF JULY 26-1956 I WAS DUTY P.O. IN THE RADAR "SHACK" - C.I.C. ON ANCHOR DETAIL - 0000 TO 0400 HOURS. ONE OTHER 3RD CLASS WAS WITH ME. 4 LOOKOUTS WERE TOPSIDE. WHILE AT ANCHOR ONLY SURFACE RADAR WAS ON LINE. OUR VL RADAR WAS DOWN (HEIGHT RADAR). ONE LOOKOUT THEN ANOTHER CALLED IN THAT TWO STRANGE OBJECTS WERE IN THE AIR BUT DID NOT KNOW WHAT. I PUT A VL INTO OPERATION - WENT TOPSIDE TO SEE FOR MYSELF. WHAT YOU SEE IN THE ENCLOSED SKETCH IS WHAT I SAW THAT NIGHT 35 YEARS AGO. I CALLED FOR THE DUTY OFFICER OF THE DAY AND HE IN TURN CALLED OTHERS.

THESE "THINGS" WERE WATCHED BY MANY FOR

ABOUT 5-7 MINUTES. ALL POSSIBLE REASONS FOR THESE OBJECTS PROVED WRONG OTHER THAN THE FACT THEY HAD NO REASON TO BE THERE.

MY ORIGINAL SKETCH WENT TO THE DEFENCE DEPT., BUT IT STUCK IN MY MIND ALL THESE YEARS. I MADE THE ENCLOSED SKETCH IN 1982 FROM A "ROUGH ONE" THAT I HAD TO TELL NO ONE TO FOR 20 YEARS.

THE FOLLOWING NAMES MAY HELP YOU IF THEY ARE ALIVE TODAY.

F.D.R. COMMANDING OFFICER: CAPTAIN JOHN T. HAYWARD
6 APRIL 1956 - 1 OCTOBER 1956
C.I.C. → OPERATIONS OFFICER: COMMANDER WHITNEY WRIGHT-USN.
NAVIGATOR: COMMANDER JAMES R. THOMSON

I THINK YOU WILL FIND, MR. GRUSINSKI, THAT BRAZIL HAS BEEN THE AREA OF MANY U.F.O. SIGHTINGS OVER THE PAST 100 YEARS.

I HOPE THIS HAS BEEN OF HELP TO YOU. YOU MAY USE MY NAME AND THE ENCLOSED IF YOU WISH. I HOPE YOU LET ME KNOW WHAT TAKES PLACE

I AM NOW 57 YEARS OF AGE - A RETIRED HEAVY CONSTRUCTION WORKER AND A FREE-LANCE ARTIST WHO ENJOYS HISTORICAL EVENTS. I AM NOW WORKING ON A 9X5 FOOT OIL PAINTING OF THE 20TH MAINE AT THE BATTLE OF GETTYSBURG - CIVIL WAR 1863.

BEST OF LUCK TO YOU. I ENJOYED MY NAVY DAYS. GOOD OR BAD.

BEST WISHES
Leon Treadwell
Ex P03-O.I. Div.
F.D.R.-CVA-42
1956-1958

P.S.. LOST THE SIGHT OF MY LEFT EYE 3 YEARS AGO.
ALWAYS LIKED WESTERN GEAR. BOOTS & ALL SINCE 1950